6.5 Windows Firewall

Windows Firewall builds on the firewall introduced under XP to offer a bidirectional firewall which tracks and filters both inbound and outgoing traffic under Vista.

Windows Firewall Off Settings

By default, the Vista firewall blocks all incoming traffic unless it is solicited or matches a rule, and allows all outgoing traffic unless it matches a rule. These rules can be set or modified through the Exceptions List: go to **Start > Control Panel > Security**, and then "Allow a program through Windows Firewall". You can also set rules for the firewall, in order to configure it for various services and protocols:

- Active Directory accounts and groups
- IP protocol number

Settings for Windows Firewall

Firewall-exceptions